

Rental Application Fast-Track Checklist — Queensland

Win the lease, even with no rental history or connections.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Know Your Rights Before You Apply

- ☐ [] **Understand the standardised application form.** Since May 2025, Queensland requires the use of a **standardised rental application form (Form 22)**, with new rules limiting what personal information can be collected, how it's stored, and how it must be destroyed.
- ☐ [] **Know your data is protected.** Agents and landlords can't request excessive personal information beyond what the prescribed form requires, and must handle what they do collect in line with the new privacy rules.
- ☐ [] **Know Queensland's tenancy law is administered under the Residential Tenancies and Rooming Accommodation Regulation 2025**, with the **Residential Tenancies Authority (RTA)** holding bonds and providing dispute resolution, and the **Queensland Civil and Administrative Tribunal (QCAT)** hearing disputes.

Section 2 — Documents to Have Ready

- ☐ [] **Photo ID** (driver's licence or passport).
- ☐ [] **Proof of income** — payslips, employment letter, or for students/first-time renters: Centrelink statements, scholarship confirmation, or guarantor documents.
- ☐ [] **Rental history/references** — previous landlord/agent details, or alternative references if you're a first-time renter.
- ☐ [] **Bank statements**, if requested and permitted under Form 22's scope.

Section 3 — The Application Itself

- ☐ [] **Apply promptly after inspecting** — competitive Brisbane and South East Queensland properties can attract high application volumes quickly.
- ☐ [] **Only provide information the Form 22 actually requests** — you're entitled to decline requests for anything beyond this.
- ☐ [] **Attend the inspection in person if possible.**
- ☐ [] **Follow up politely, once**, if you haven't heard back within a few days.

Section 4 — Renting With Pets

- ☐ [] **Submit pet requests in writing.** Landlords must respond within **14 days**, or consent is **deemed granted** if they don't.
- ☐ [] **Know refusals must be on "reasonable grounds"** — a blanket no-pets policy without a stated, reasonable reason isn't compliant.

Section 5 — For Students & First-Time Renters Specifically

- ☐ [] **Consider a guarantor** if you lack independent rental/income history — confirm the specific agency genuinely accepts this.
- ☐ [] **Highlight stability signals** — enrolment confirmation, course length, stable casual work history.
- ☐ [] **Consider co-applying with reliable housemates** for a stronger combined application.
- ☐ [] **Don't be discouraged by rejections** in a competitive market — apply for multiple properties in parallel.

Quick Reference — Key QLD Rental Application Rules

RULE	DETAIL
Standardised application form	Form 22, mandatory since May 2025
Personal information handling	New collection, storage and destruction rules since May 2025
Pet request response	14 days, or deemed granted
Bond holder	Residential Tenancies Authority (RTA)
Dispute resolution	Queensland Civil and Administrative Tribunal (QCAT)

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